

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Would you like to swim with seals?



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What is your point of view regarding animal conservation? Are you worried about endangered species? Why?
- Would you consider volunteering for an animal rights group?

Can Do Statements

- I can write a short descriptive paragraph about nature and the animal world.
- I can write about feelings and impressions.
- I can discuss how to deal with problems.





Let's Explore!

Have you been to the seal exhibit yet? It's amazing what you can learn at the **aquarium***.

* An "aquarium" is a zoo that has tanks of water in which fish and other water creatures and plants are kept.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Presenter:** Welcome to the seal exhibit! These monk seals were brought here by the Seal Conservation Society.
- Jeffrey:** I'm amazed by their speed in the water. Aren't seals common in the wild?
- Presenter:** There is conflicting information about whether seals are endangered or not. However, it is well documented that the Mediterranean monk seal, a species along the coastline of Africa, is critically endangered. There are only 600 of them remaining in the wild.
- Jeffrey:** That's upsetting and worrying to hear. Only 600?
- Presenter:** In 1997, two-thirds of them were wiped out by a virus. Since then, conservationists have worked to increase their numbers. Many seals were hunted for their meat by poor communities.
- Jeffrey:** I'm shocked at those numbers. So if conservationists had not decided to try to make a difference, these seals would be extinct? That's frightening!
- Presenter:** It's very possible. The Seal Conservation Society has been in place since 1996. This non-profit organization has worked to create marine areas to provide food supplies for the seals and the people who live in the area. That way, the monk seal is not the main food supply in the area.
- Melissa:** Are they involved with the other animal rights groups?
- Presenter:** Yes, they work very closely with other animal rights groups. They also contact political figures to push for further protection of seals and strive to offer educational materials for schools too.
- Melissa:** If younger generations learn to be compassionate towards animals they should be more interested in looking after endangered wildlife.
- Presenter:** Exactly! Conservation is essential to the longevity of many species. If future generations are not committed to protecting endangered animals, our diverse ecosystems could be lost.



Let's Practice!

How can people deal with issues associated with* endangered wildlife?

*To be "associated with" means to be connected with something else.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. lost. / protecting / our / to / not / If / diverse / ecosystems / be / endangered / future / generations / animals, / could / committed / are

2. be / endangered / to / more / in / generations / should/ If / they / towards / wildlife. / compassionate / after / be / looking / interested / animals / younger / learn



Let's Practice!

How do the visitors feel about this topic?

Instructions: Read the sentences. Fill out the crossword with feelings and impressions.

Down

1. Having seals become extinct is a _____ situation.

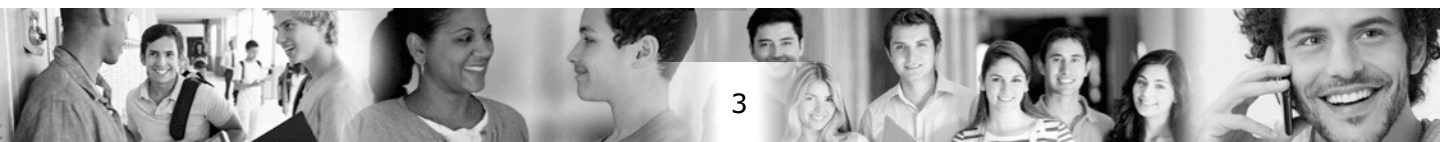
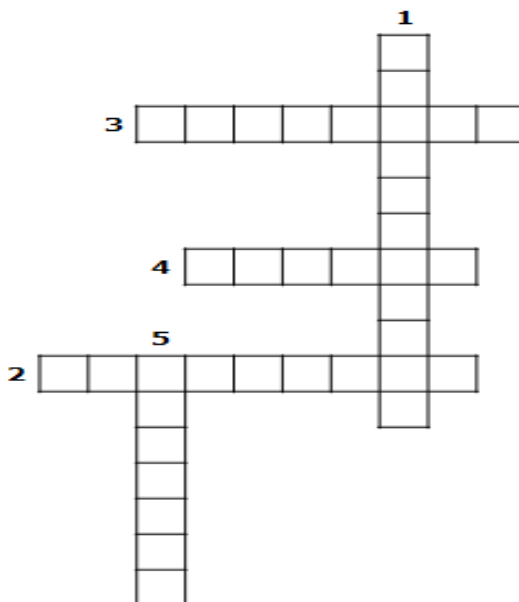
5. A person is _____ by the number of seals remaining in the wild.

Across

2. It's _____ to know that information.

3. That's _____ to hear.

4. A person is _____ by the seals' speed in the water.





Extension Activity

Do you know any animals that are close to extinction in your country? It's time to conduct some research.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and research an endangered animal from around the world.
- Write notes including the population left in the wild, the conservation efforts and the location of the animals.
- Write two 60 word paragraphs about what you learned.
- Use adjectives ending in *-ed* and *-ing* like *It was interesting to learn about.*
- Use the passive voice i.e. *The monk seal was almost hunted to extinction by fishermen.*
- Read your paragraph(s) aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I research endangered animals online.

☐ ☐

I write a paragraph about an endangered animal.

☐ ☐

I write a paragraph in the passive voice.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **exhibit** (noun): an object or a collection of objects that have been put out in a public space for people to look at
e.g. Welcome to the seal exhibit!
- **endangered** (adjective): used to describe a type of animal or plant that has become very rare and that could die out completely
e.g. They should be more interested in looking after endangered wildlife.
- **virus** (noun): an extremely small living thing that causes a disease and that spreads from one person or animal to another
e.g. These two animals were stuck down with a virus.
- **conservationist** (noun): a person whose work involves protecting the earth's animals, plants and natural resources
e.g. Since then, conservationists have worked to increase their numbers.
- **to strive** (verb): to try very hard to do or achieve something
e.g. They strive to provide educational materials for all schools.
- **longevity** (noun): long life; the fact of living for many years
e.g. Conservation is essential to the longevity of many species.
- **diverse** (adjective): different from each other
e.g. Our diverse environment could be lost.
- **ecosystem** (noun): all things that are part of a specific environment
Example: There are many plants and animals in each ecosystem.





Learning Points

Writing a Descriptive Paragraph Using the Passive Form

Verbs may be active or passive. In sentences with active verbs, the subject performs ("does") the action. In sentences with passive verbs, the subject receives the action.

Passive verbs always have at least two parts: a form of BE and a past participle.

You can use the passive form when the receiver of the action is more important than the doer, or should be emphasized. You can also use the passive form when you are not sure who or what is doing the action. You also use passive form when you don't want to say who is doing the action.

Examples:

- *The tour was organized by the group leader.*
- *The Seal Conservation Society was created by individuals who wanted to protect animals.*
- *In 1997, two-thirds of them were wiped out by a virus.*
- *Many seals were hunted for their meat by poor communities.*

Writing About Feelings and Impressions

You talk about feelings and reactions using adjectives.

Adjectives that end in **-ed** are used to describe how a person feels, like *annoyed*, *fascinated*, *entertained*, *surprised*, *worried* or *tired*.

Adjectives that end in **-ing** are used to describe things and situations, like *annoying*, *entertaining*, *surprising*, *worrying* or *tiring*. These adjectives describe the effect something has on a person.

Examples:

- *I'm amazed by their speed in the water.*
- *That's upsetting and worrying to hear.*
- *That's frightening!*

